

Qualification Programme
Module 5 – Information Management
Report on Candidates' Performance
(December 2023 Session)

(The main purpose of the following report is to summarise candidates' common weaknesses and make recommendations to help future candidates improve their performance in the examination.)

This paper consisted of 45 multiple-choice questions. Candidates had one hour and forty-five minutes to complete the paper. The questions of this paper related broadly to the following Principal Learning Outcomes:

- (a) Analyse the role of e-Commerce;
- (b) Analyse the risks and security of information management;
- (c) Categorise the nature and account for the value of information systems;
- (d) Describe and apply corporate information systems;
- (e) Analyse systems development process; and
- (f) Use information technology applications.

The multiple-choice questions in this paper were divided into two broad categories, which were worth 1 to 2 marks each:

- Knowledge-based questions; and
- Application-based questions.

General Comments

The average marks (in percentage) scored by candidates for questions of the topic areas are as follows:

(a) Analyse the role of e-Commerce	67.7%
(b) Analyse the risks and security of information management	43.1%
(c) Categorise the nature and account for the value of information systems	62.6%
(d) Describe and apply corporate information systems	62.4%
(e) Analyse systems development process	45.6%
(f) Use information technology applications	69.6%

The average marks (in percentage) scored by candidates for the two broad categories of questions are as follows:

• Knowledge-based questions	62.8%
• Application-based questions	43.8%

In general, the candidates' performance in this session was satisfactory. Candidates exhibited competence in analysing the role of e-Commerce, categorising the nature and accounting for the value of information systems, describing and applying corporate information systems, and using information technology applications. However, their proficiency in analysing the risks and security of information management, and analysing systems development process was relatively weaker.

Specific Comments

In this session, candidates demonstrated weakest performance in questions covering the following topics:

- Apply the following types of information technology general controls:
 - Physical and logical
 - Organisational
 - Procedural
- Describe the necessary activities involved in all the stages of the systems development life cycle (SDLC) as follows:
 - Systems analysis
 - Systems design
 - Systems implementation
 - Systems testing
 - Systems evaluation
 - Systems operation and maintenance
- Solve the behavioural issues of implementing information systems in entities
- Justify how change management can contribute to successful implementation of information systems

Specifically, candidates encountered difficulties with the specialised topic of applying physical and logical information technology general controls. It appears that candidates may not have prepared sufficiently for the topic.

Additionally, candidates should thoroughly consider the context of the question and its requirements, grasp the related conceptual theories, and effectively apply them when responding to application-based questions. To ensure a comprehensive understanding of how to approach multiple-choice questions, candidates are encouraged to study the [Tips for Answering Multiple Choice Questions](#) available on the HKICPA website. Furthermore, candidates are reminded that it is essential to select only one answer for each multiple-choice question.